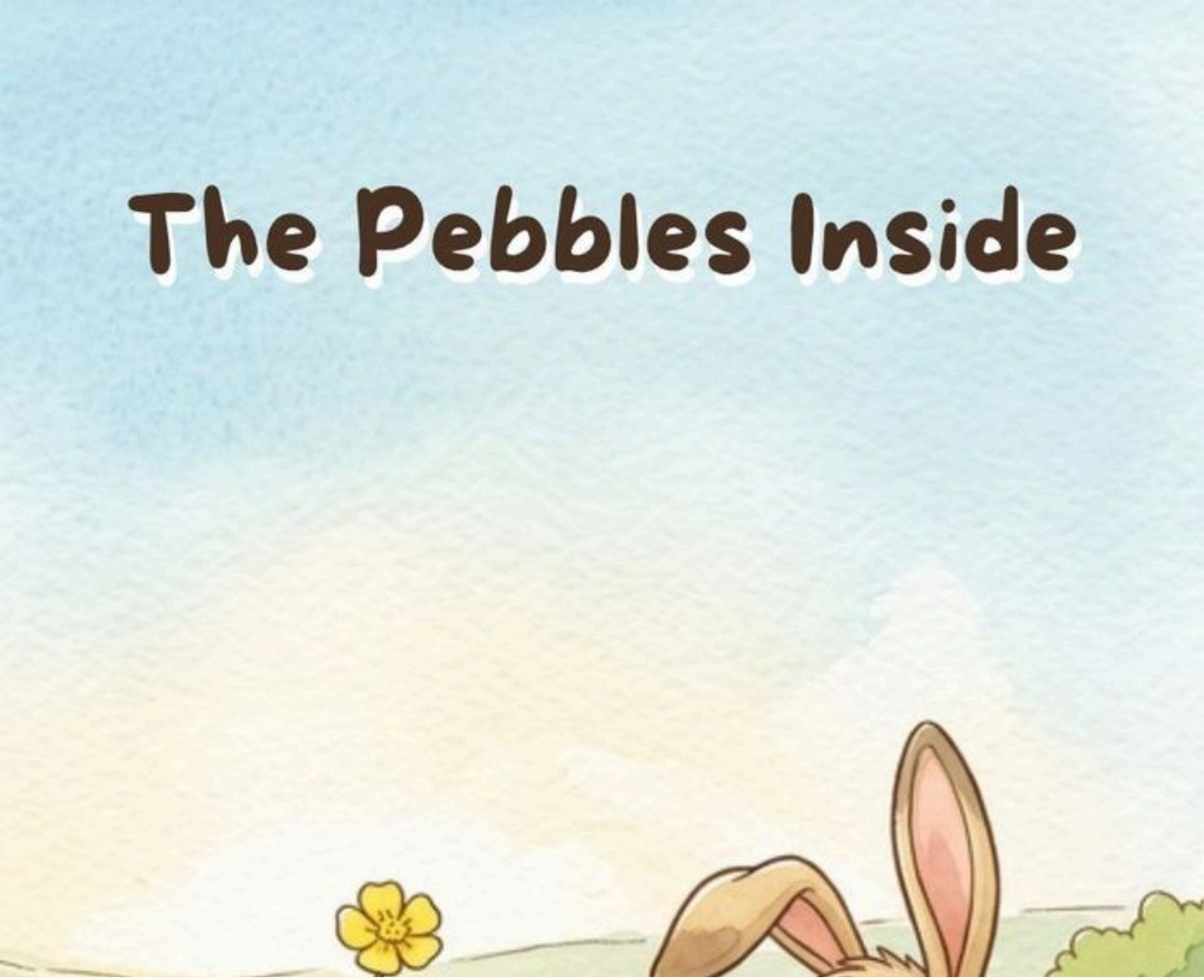


Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

The Pebbles Inside

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: sharing feelings.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

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For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

Feelings we keep inside can feel heavy. Telling someone we trust makes them lighter, and good friends listen.

Say it together

‘I’m fine.’ Click.

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
pebble	a small, smooth stone	pinch a tiny pebble between your fingers
heavy	hard to lift or carry	pretend to lift something with both arms
feeling	what happens in your heart, like happy, sad or scared	put your hand on your heart
share	to give some to someone else, or tell them	move your hands from your chest to a friend
listen	to pay attention to what someone says	cup your hand behind your ear

A gentle note

This guide is not therapy. If a child seems withdrawn or worried for a long time, talk with their family and your school team.

Real stones can be a choking hazard for under-3s. Use paper pebbles or very large stones with a grown-up close by.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

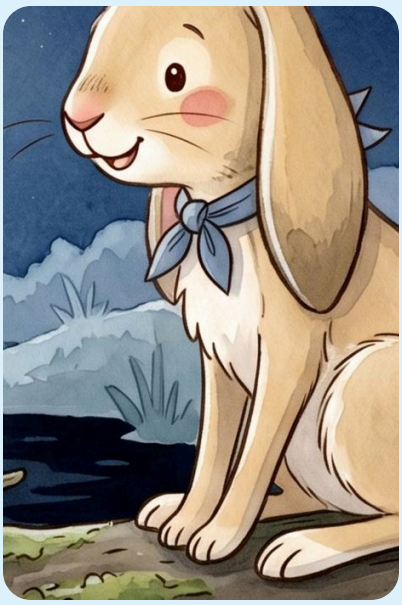
Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Tavi

European pond turtle

The quiet turtle who learns to share what she carries



Fern

European hare

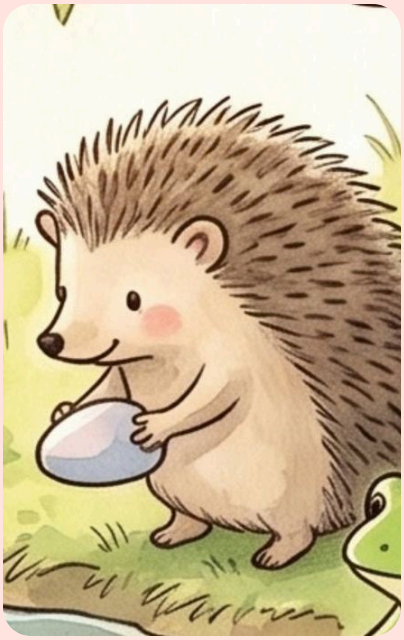
The best friend who sits down and stays



The frogs

Green water frogs

They laughed, then one came to say sorry



The hedgehog

European hedgehog

Brings a pebble for the path



The duck

Mallard

Sets down a pebble she had kept inside

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How did they feel?

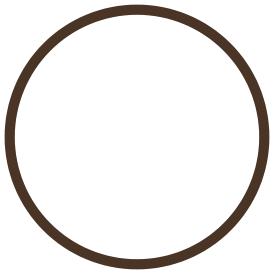
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

The frogs laugh; Tavi says ‘I’m fine.’ Why did Tavi say ‘I’m fine’

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

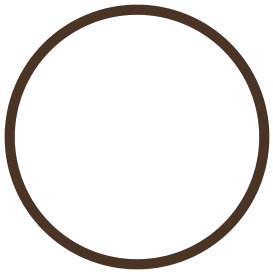


Moment 2

Tavi shares the first pebble.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

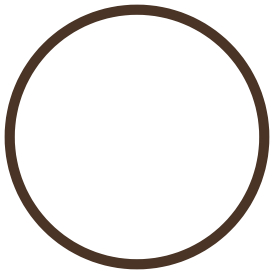


Moment 3

The pebbles become a path.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

pebble a small, smooth stone

pebble pebble

heavy hard to lift or carry

heavy heavy

feeling what happens in your heart, like happy, sad or scared

feeling feeling

Tavi the hero of the story

Tavi Tavi

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Tavi showed sharing feelings. Draw a time when you showed sharing feelings too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

The heavy backpack

You need: A small backpack, soft objects

A volunteer wears the backpack. Each time the class names a feeling someone might hide, add one soft object. Ask: Is it getting heavy? Then take them out one by one as the class names who you could tell.

Pebble feelings

Find a few smooth pebbles. Hold one and say one feeling out loud. Put it down. Feel lighter?

Stepping stones

Make a path with cushions or paper 'stones'. Say one thing you feel on each step.

Hare hop

How far can you jump? A hare can leap about 3 metres!

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in The Pebbles Inside are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Tavi

European pond turtle

When the weather is bad, babies can stay inside their eggs for a whole winter and hatch in spring!



Fern

European hare

In spring, hares stand up and box with their front paws. Often it's a mom telling a dad to back off!



The frogs

Green water frogs

Edible frogs croak 20 to 30 times every second, in a fast rattling song.



The hedgehog

European hedgehog

A hedgehog can lose 20–40% of its weight while it hibernates.

Story or real?

Real pond turtles are dark brown or black with little yellow spots, not bright green like Tavi. And they don't keep pebbles on their shells! But they really do love quiet ponds and brooks.

Where they really live

The willow brook has no real name, so we picked the Brenne Regional Natural Park in France. It's the best place in France to meet a European pond turtle like Tavi, along with frogs, ducks and lots of other pond life.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-pebbles-inside

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What is the turtle carrying? How do you think she feels?

The Pebbles Inside, talk card 1

Why did Tavi say ‘I’m fine’ when she wasn’t?

The Pebbles Inside, talk card 2

What happened to Tavi’s shell as she kept more feelings inside?

The Pebbles Inside, talk card 3

What did Fern do that helped Tavi feel safe to talk?

The Pebbles Inside, talk card 4

Why do you think the frog laughed at Tavi? What did he do later?

The Pebbles Inside, talk card 5

Who could you tell when you have a ‘pebble’ inside?

The Pebbles Inside, talk card 6

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Sharing feelings hero

This is to say that

_____

showed sharing feelings, just like Tavi.

‘I’m fine.’ Click.

_____ _____

Signed Date

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